



ADVERBS

The words that describe verbs, adjectives or other adverbs

1 What is it?

Adverbs (AD-vurbz)

An adverb is a word that gives more information about a verb, an adjective, or another adverb — often telling us how, when, where, or to what extent.

often ends in **-ly** + describes an action

2 See it in action

How

"She spoke **quietly** and **calmly**."

When

"We'll leave **soon**, but not **immediately**."

Where

"He looked **everywhere** and searched **outside**."

To what extent

"It was **extremely** cold and **very** windy."



Good spot!

Try asking 'how', 'when', 'where' or 'how much' about a verb in your sentence — the word that answers is usually an adverb.

3 More to know

Adverb of frequency

"She **always** arrives early, but **rarely** stays late."

Modifying an adjective

"It was **surprisingly** good and **remarkably** cheap."

FUN FACT

The adverb "very" is one of the most overused words in student writing — professional editors often suggest cutting it entirely, since a stronger single word ("exhausted" instead of "very tired") usually does the job better.

4 Why it's used

Adverbs help: add precision to actions and descriptions — they tell the reader exactly how, when, where or how much something happened.

Many adverbs are formed by adding -ly to an adjective (quiet → quietly), but not all — words like "fast", "soon" and "often" are adverbs without an -ly ending.



Quick reminder!

Remember: 'friendly' looks like an adverb but is actually an adjective — always check the meaning, not just the ending.

5 Don't mix it up

ADVERBS

Adverbs describe a VERB, adjective or other adverb — "she spoke quietly" (describes the verb spoke).

ADJECTIVES

Adjectives describe a NOUN only — "a quiet room" (describes the noun room), never a verb.

⚠ Watch out!

Not every -ly word is an adverb, and not every adverb ends in -ly — "friendly" is actually an adjective (a friendly dog), while "fast" and "well" are adverbs with no -ly at all.

6 Quick recap

Describes verbs/adjectives

Answers how/when/where

Not all end in -ly



Keep going!

Swap a weak adverb + adjective combo (very tired) for one strong word (exhausted) to sharpen your writing.